

Best Practices for Securing Your Zoom Sessions

Everything you need to know to keep your video communications safe and secure



BdREN Zoom is helping thousands of teachers and students to connect more productively, reliably, and securely with online classes. Zoom continuously working to provide a safe and secure environment for all Zoom users. The Zoom platform comes loaded with host controls and number of security features designed to effectively manage meetings and classes prevent disruption, and help users communicate remotely.

In this guide, learn about how you can secure your virtual sessions. The following content is separated into three distinct sections. The first section focuses on all the steps you can take to secure your meeting before it starts. The second section highlights all the controls that a Zoom Meeting host has at their disposal during a Zoom Meeting. The final section highlights a list of additional resources available to continue learning and become a Zoom Meeting expert.

About Zoom

Zoom is one of the popular tool for video communications, with an easy, reliable cloud platform for video and audio conferencing, collaboration, chat, and webinars across mobile devices, desktops, telephones, and room systems. Founded in 2011, Zoom helps businesses and organizations bring their teams together in a frictionless environment to get more done. Zoom is a publicly-traded company on Nasdaq (ticker: ZM) and headquartered in San Jose, California.

Part 1

Pre-Meeting Settings

With meeting settings in the Zoom web portal and the Zoom application, securing your Zoom Meetings can start before your event even begins.

TIP Turn on Your Waiting Room

One of the best ways to secure your meeting is to turn on Zoom's Waiting Room feature. Some Zoom users, like those in education, will have this feature turned on by default. This feature provides a virtual waiting room for your attendees and allows you to admit individual meeting participants into your meeting at your discretion.

Turn on Your Waiting Room

Users can enable Waiting Room as a default account setting, for individual meetings, or as a meeting template. [Learn more about Waiting Rooms.](#)

View and Admit Participants

As meeting attendees arrive, Zoom will notify you and provide you a list of those in the meeting, and those still in the waiting room, so you have total control of who joins your meeting.

Customize the Experience

Once enabled, you can tailor your Waiting Room title, logo, and description, customizing what participants see when they arrive.

Message the Waiting Room

If you're meeting with a smaller group of attendees, one attendee at a time, or your previous meeting is running long, you can message everyone in the waiting room and let them know.

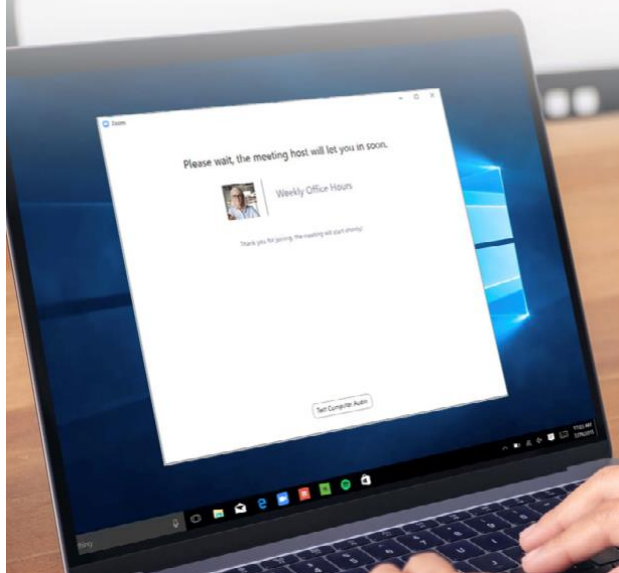
Add Additional Helpful Info

The description on your Waiting Room is a great place to add additional information, meeting guidelines, or rules for participants to follow.

Remove Participants

Once you've admitted an attendee into your meeting, you can easily push them back to the Waiting Room or remove them from the meeting all together, and can even prevent their return.

Attendee Experience



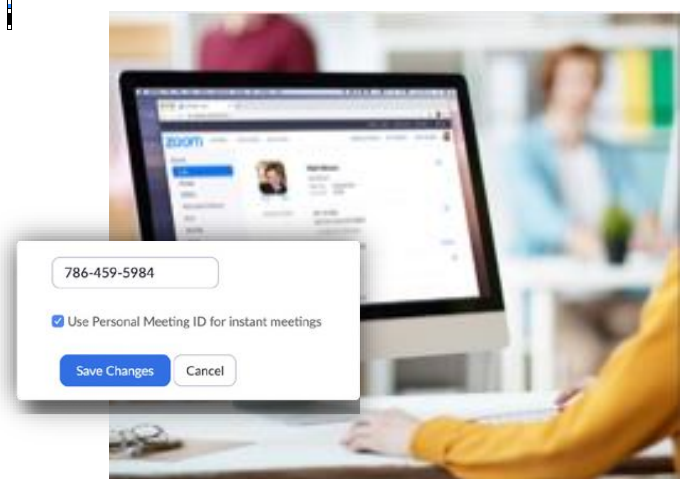
Host Experience



TIP Make someone a co-host to admit participants from the waiting list. It may ease your meeting controlling task.

Don't Use Personal Meeting ID for Public Meetings

Your **Personal Meeting ID (PMI)** is the default meeting that launches when you start an ad hoc meeting. Your PMI doesn't change unless you change it yourself, which makes it very useful if people need a way to reach you. But for public meetings or classes, you should always schedule new meetings with randomly generated meeting IDs. That way, only invited attendees will know how to join your meeting. You can also turn off your PMI when starting an instant meeting in your profile settings.



Require a Passcode to Join

You can take meeting security even further by requiring a passcode to join your meetings. This feature can be applied to both your Personal Meeting ID, so only those with the passcode will be able to reach you, and to newly scheduled meetings. To learn all the ways to add a passcode for your meetings, please view [this support article](#).

Only Allow Registered or Domain Verified Users

Zoom can also give you peace of mind by letting you know exactly who will be attending your meeting. When scheduling a meeting, you can **require attendees to register** with their e-mail, name, and custom questions. You can even customize your registration page with a banner and logo. By default, Zoom also restricts participants to those who are logged into Zoom, and you can even restrict it to Zoom users who's email address uses a certain domain.



Part 2

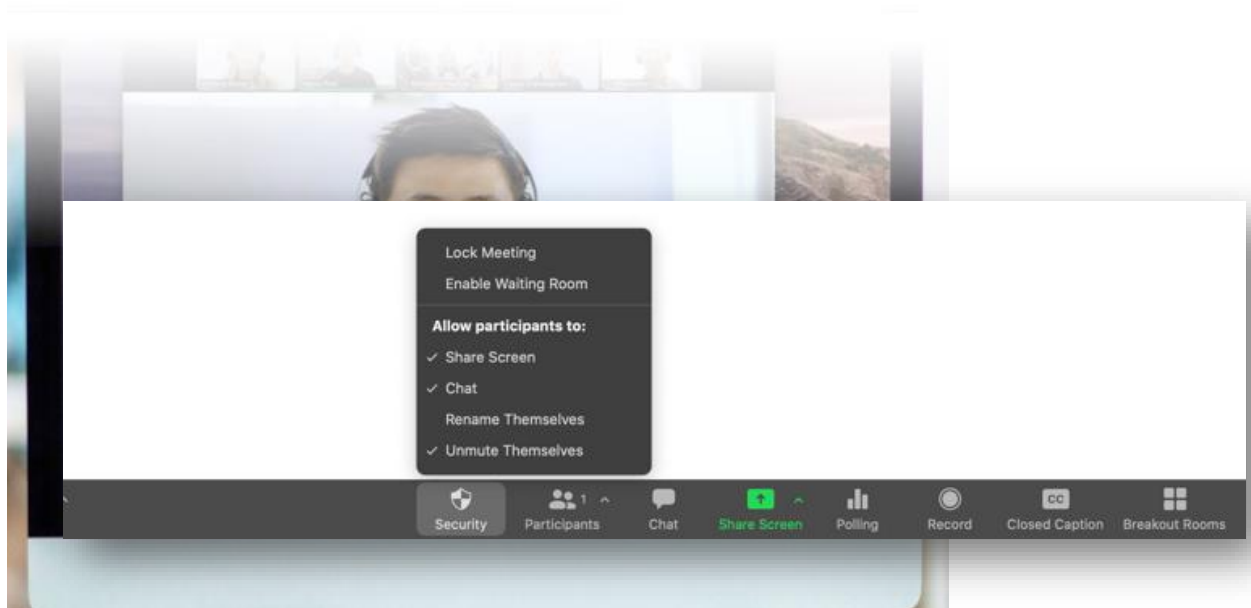
In-Meeting Settings

Once your Zoom Meeting is off and running you'll have access to a number of helpful features that put you in total control.

TIP

Master the Security Menu

Zoom now puts all your essential security options in a single button, right in the in-meeting menu. Under this menu you'll be able to lock your meeting and prevent any new participants from joining. You'll also be able to enable Waiting Room to help manage new meeting participants and be able to control any sharing and chat permissions of individuals and all attendees.



Lock the Meeting

Once all your attendees have arrived, you can easily lock your meeting from the security menu, preventing any additional attendees from joining.

Enable Waiting Room

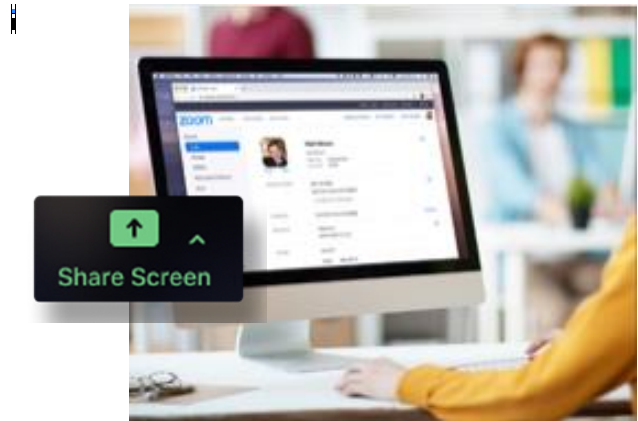
We've covered the Waiting Room in great detail already, but what if you forgot to activate it or want to turn it on mid-meeting? Now you can!

Manage Participants

In the following page, we'll dive into all the ways you can manage your participants directly from the security menu, giving you total control.

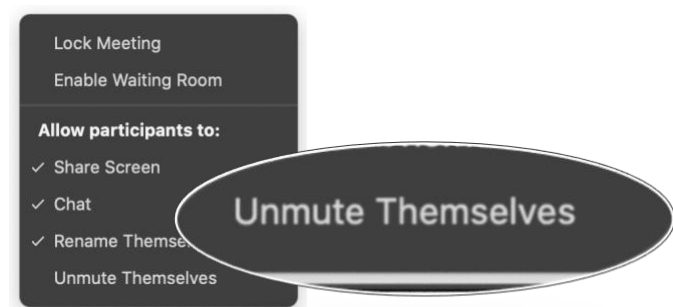
Control Screen Sharing

Allowing participants to screen share in a meeting can be a great way to collaborate, but that can also leave you open to unwanted interruptions during larger meetings. Zoom gives you the ability to determine if you want other participants in the meeting to be able to share their screens, or if you want to be the only one with that ability. You can easily toggle this feature on and off from the screen sharing menu, as well as the security menu.



Disable Rename

Do not allow participants to rename their ID: The host can disable the ability for participants to rename their onscreen identity.



Disable Private Chat

In-meeting chat adds another dimension of collaboration to your meetings, creating a place for questions to be asked and fielded later, or for supplemental resources to be posted. But sometimes chat can become distracting or unproductive. In those cases, Zoom allows you to disable and enable chat throughout your meeting.

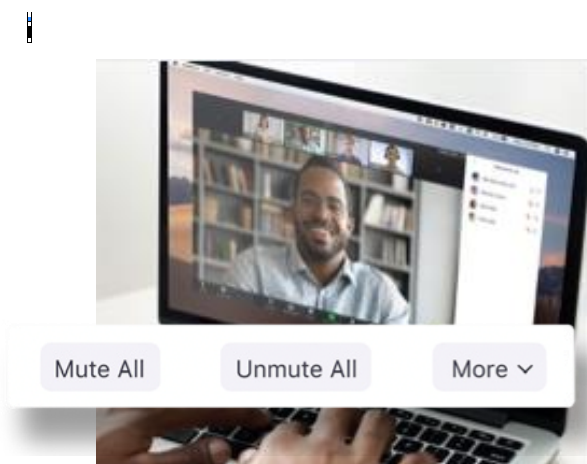


Control Participants Mic

Enabling participants to unmute themselves in a meeting can be a great way to collaborate, but that can also leave you open to unwanted noise during larger meetings. Zoom gives you the control over participants mic in the meeting. Participants won't be able to turn on their mic once you uncheck this option.

Mute Participants

We've all been in meetings where somebody forgets to mute, or their microphone picks up some background noise that interrupts the meeting. Zoom allows you to solve this problem with a simple button to mute all participants. For an added layer of security, you can also disable participant's ability to unmute themselves. When you're ready to make the meeting interactive again, you can simply hit the "Unmute All" button or allow participants to unmute themselves.

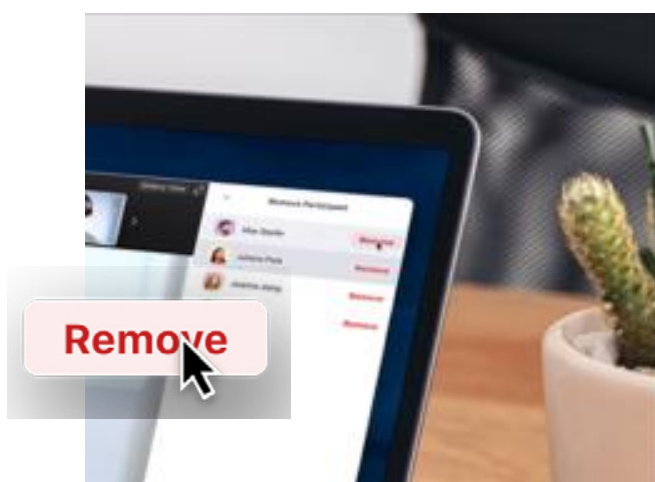


Make Someone a Co-Host

All the features we've covered so far are only accessible to meeting hosts, ensuring that hosts are the only ones with total control over a meeting. But what if you need a helping hand to manage all your participants? You can promote a trusted meeting attendee to Co-Host, allowing them many of the same privileges and control features available to the meeting host themselves. To learn about the difference between a host and co-host, view [this support article](#).

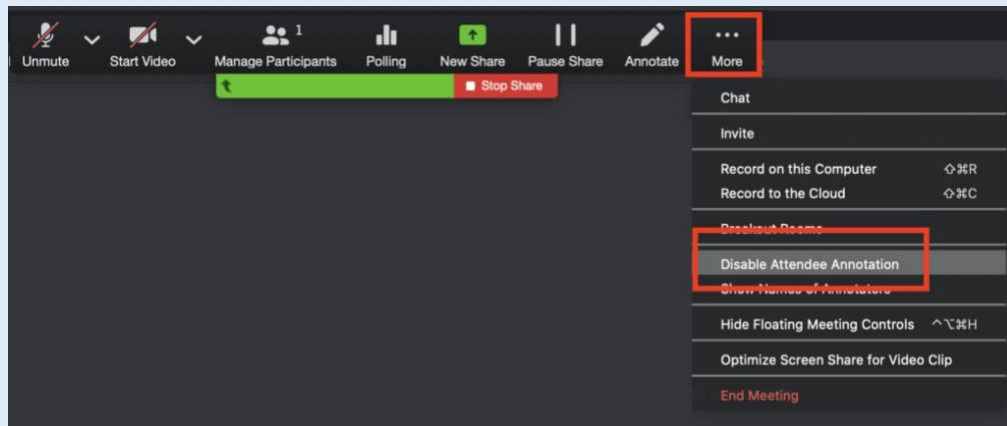
Remove Participants

If you follow all the best practices in this guide, you should never find yourself in a meeting with an unwanted guest. But if you do need to remove an attendee from the meeting at any point, Zoom makes it easy to kick an unwanted participant out of the meeting. For additional security, you can also choose to not allow participants to rejoin once they've been removed.



Turn Off Annotation

Like screen sharing and in-meeting chat, annotation can be a great tool when you need it, but it can also be an opportunity for mischief when you don't. To avoid unwanted annotation, Zoom allows you as the meeting host to remove all participants ability to annotate during a screen share. You can disable this for the entire meeting, or just temporarily.



Few More Security Settings

Put participant on hold: You can put an attendee on hold and their video and audio connections will be disabled momentarily.

Report a user: Hosts/co-hosts can report users to Zoom's Trust & Safety team, who will review any potential misuse of the platform and take appropriate action.

Disable video: Hosts can turn someone's video off from participant list. This will allow hosts to block unwanted, distracting, or inappropriate gestures on video.

Turn off file transfer: In-meeting file transfer allows people to share files through the in-meeting chat. But Malware can be shared via file transfers, so by disabling file transfer during a zoom meeting you will prevent any attendees from sharing potentially malicious files.

Control recording: The ability to record to the cloud or locally is something an account admin can control. If they have recording access, the host can decide to enable/disable a participant or all participants to record.

Disable join before host: Students cannot join class before the teacher joins and will see a pop-up that says, "The meeting is waiting for the host to join."

Enable "mute participants on entry": This function will allow the host to have all participants automatically muted upon entry. Having meeting attendees muted as they join will reduce noise disruption.

Keep your zoom application up to date: Keeping your applications up to date ensures you have the newest features and security updates installed. This should apply to all your applications, not just Zoom.

Important recommendation for teachers: We encourage you to NOT post pictures of your virtual class or the meeting link on social media or elsewhere online. While it's fun to share in the excitement of connecting over Zoom, we discourage publicly posting images in a Zoom virtual classroom.

Part 3

Additional Resources for Enhancing Security

Still have questions? There still got you covered.

If you still have questions about specific features or functionality, zoom has three resources you may find helpful. The Zoom Help Center has thousands of support articles on all things Zoom. Zoom also run weekly webinar trainings, or Zoom has recordings you can access immediately, and the Zoom Blog is a great source of new Zoom use cases and stories.

Zoom Help Center

Whether you're looking for technical documentation or a one minute quick start video, the Zoom Help Center has you covered with thousands of resources that are updated daily, so you can get your questions answered and keep Zooming.

[Visit the Help Center](#)

Live/Recorded Trainings

Zoom experts host free and interactive live training webinars daily. Get up to speed on important topics in less than an hour. Just select the time zone that fits best for you when registering for one of our live training webinars.

[View Live Trainings & Recordings](#)

Zoom Blog

Want to stay up-to-date on everything happening in the Zoom community? The Zoom blog offers daily stories on what's new at Zoom, exciting updates, and innovative customer stories and use cases to keep you inspired and on the cutting edge.

[Visit the Zoom Blog](#)





References

- i. <https://blog.zoom.us/best-practices-for-securing-your-virtual-classroom/>
- ii. <https://zoom.us/docs/en-us/privacy-and-security.html>
- iii. <https://www.tripwire.com/state-of-security/security-data-protection/getting-zoom-security-right-8-tips-family-friends/>
- iv. <https://zoom.us/docs/doc/Comprehensive%20Guide%20to%20Educating%20Through%20Zoom.pdf>